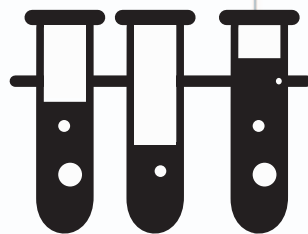


FORENSIC SCIENTIST

JOB DESCRIPTION

Forensic scientists work with the police and other law enforcement agencies to help solve crimes. Collecting samples, such as body fluids, hair, fibers, or fragments from the scene of a crime, they then process and examine the samples for evidence that may help in the identification of a suspect or victim, or provide other valuable information about the incident.



SALARY

Assistant forensic scientist ★★★★★

Senior forensic scientist ★★★★★

INDUSTRY PROFILE

New techniques in forensics, such as DNA fingerprinting, have opened specialized job opportunities • Fierce competition for jobs

CAREER PATHS

A degree in a scientific subject is the most common first step in this career. You begin as a trainee, supporting forensic scientists in the lab. With experience, you can go on to manage teams of scientists, or move into private consultancy, where you may investigate the causes of industrial fires or accidents.

GRADUATE Although you may be able to find work as a lab assistant with only a high school diploma, the most common route into the profession is to earn a degree. Graduates in chemistry, biology, biochemistry, or medical science are the usual recruits, but opportunities are also available for graduates in computer science.

POSTGRADUATE You may stand a better chance of getting a job with graduate training in a specialty such as ballistics (firearms) or fingerprint examination.

DNA ANALYST Analyzes human genetic material, DNA. This lab-based job in a fast-growing, cutting-edge specialty of forensics demands an in-depth knowledge of DNA sequencing techniques and how to interpret genetic data.



FORENSIC SCIENTIST Most of your training will be on the job. After a few years' experience, you will likely be called as "expert witness" to give evidence in court. Alternatively, you can apply for management positions or enter private consultancy.